

LAURA JOHN

Art Teacher

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Rockville, MD



SUMMARY

Graphic Design, Yearbook, and Ceramics Teacher with over 12 years of experience, adept at blending traditional art techniques with modern digital tools to foster creativity and innovation in students. Skilled in digital photography, graphic design, ceramics, and photojournalism/yearbook with a proven track record of tripling program enrollment and managing a \$50k budget. Committed to nurturing a diverse and inclusive learning environment, preparing students for future success in a dynamic artistic landscape.

EDUCATION

George Washington University

Corcoran School of Art + Design
Masters of Art in Teaching, Art Education

Hollins University

Bachelor of Arts, Theater

SKILLS

- Graphic Design
- Digital Photography
- Ceramics – Brent Wheels and Skutt Kilns
- Mid-fire glazing/firing (ceramics)
- Electric and Raku Kilns
- Yearbook Journalism
- Adobe Certified
- 3D Printing - Creality
- Laser Engraving- Glowforge
- Digital Cutting - Cricut
- Classroom Management
- Budget Management
- Veracross
- Blackbaud
- Canvas
- eDesign Yearbook Design Software

CERTIFICATIONS

- Maryland Advanced Professional Teaching License
- Adobe Certified
- CPR and First Aid certifications

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ceramics/Graphic Design/Photography Teacher –

Landon School | 2013 – Present

Teaching Experience:

- Teaches ceramics in a multi-level classroom, including hand building, wheel throwing, surface decoration techniques, firing, and glazing, while managing a ceramics studio, kilns, and firing schedules for a department of 8 teachers in multiple buildings.
- Teaches graphic design and digital photography using manual DSLR cameras and the Adobe Creative Suite.
- Orders supplies and manages the budget for the ceramics, graphic design, and photography programs.
- Expanded the ceramics program, tripling enrollment over 5 years.
- Integrates 3D printing, screen printing, laser engraving and digital design into ceramics projects.
- Advises students on planning and completion of AP art portfolios.
- Centers teaching on respect, empathy, teamwork, and perseverance, creating a supportive and collaborative classroom environment where students feel safe and supported when expressing their ideas, accomplishments, and failures.
- Emphasizes creative thinking in art, encouraging students to explore innovative, cutting-edge techniques and develop their unique artistic voices.
- Designed and ran summer photography camps for 13 to 18-year-olds from 2014 to 2019. Teaching summer ceramics program for ages 12 to 18-year-olds. (Summer 2025)

Projects and Community Engagement:

- Organizes student work for community art sales, raising money for student financial aid and professional development.
- Has taught and mentored students who have won national awards including a Scholastic Silver Key and AP scores of 5.

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Professional Development:

- Up to date on the latest advances in ceramics, digital art, photography, and graphic design.
- Attends annual professional workshops and National Art Education Association conferences.

Yearbook Advisor

Landon School | 2013 - Present

Project Management:

- Coordinates all yearbook activities from concept to final publication and distribution.
- Oversees the creation of yearbook content, ensuring high standards of quality and accuracy, while utilizing new design trends and creative concepts to keep the yearbook fresh and engaging.
- Edits and proofreads student submissions for appropriateness, style, grammar, and consistency.
- Manages timelines, budgets, and resources to meet publication deadlines.
- Organizes all official school portrait days and team photo days with outside vendors.
- Utilizes software such as Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator to create visually appealing yearbook spreads.

Leadership and Team Management:

- Leads and mentors a team of 15-18 high school boys, developing their journalism, photography, and design skills.
- Fosters a collaborative environment, encouraging creativity and accountability.
- Produces a 320-page yearbook covering grades 3-12 and ensured timely and budget-conscious completion for 12 years.

REFERENCES

Professional references supplied upon request.